Design system

Date: 2026-11-03. One token layer for mobve.com and the staff app. Source of values: `design-system/mobve-design-system.css`. Reference page with live specimens: `design-system/index.html`.

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1. Principles

- Few chosen colors; every state and tint is calculated from them with color-mix(), so nothing drifts out of sync.
- Every interactive control has hover, pressed, focus, disabled, loading and error states, each distinct in color and position.
- Nothing smaller than 12 px; controls 44 px high.
- Color never carries meaning alone: status always comes with an icon or text.
- Target: WCAG 2.2 AA. Every text pair is calculated.

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2. Color

2.1 Base, 6

Token	Value	Use	Contrast
--color-primary	#0b63ce	Buttons, links, selected state, focus, information, logo	white text 5.69:1
--color-secondary	#ffc845	Highlights, featured badge, second chart series, accents on the dark band. Never text on paper	ink on it 11.21:1
--color-ink	#101b2b	All text and the dark band	17.3:1 on paper
--color-paper	#ffffff	Surfaces: header, sidebar, cards, panels, inputs	
--color-muted	#536173	Secondary text, captions, placeholders and control borders	6.32:1 on paper
--color-bg	#fafafa	Page background, as in the current app	muted text 6.05:1

2.2 Semantic, from traffic lights

State	Signal	Text	Tint	Reference
Success	#03a14a (3.39:1 on paper, graphics)	#09672e (7.02:1)	#e1f4e9, 12 percent	green #00a651
Warning	#f7a30d (ink on it 8.4:1)	#7d5002 (6.95:1)	#fef0d8, 16 percent	amber #ffbf00
Error	#d73431 (white text 4.75:1)	#a12623 (7.45:1)	#fbebea, 10 percent	red #e30613
Information	uses the primary and its tint			

The signal marks the state (badge dot, notice border, error border, destructive button, chart status). Text stays in the dark version. The amber warning sits close to the secondary yellow: keep the secondary away from status and always show a warning with its icon and text.

2.3 Appointment categories

Category	Value	On paper	Before	Purposes (inferred, to confirm)
Tour	#0891c9	3.56:1	#2a78d6	Tour, Second Tour
Lease	#794db6	5.92:1	#8654b3	Lease Signing, Renewal Meeting, Document Review, Key Pickup
Inspection	#6a7a31	4.73:1	#167a77	Move In Inspection, Move Out Inspection, Move In
Billing	#b55fba	3.95:1	#5956c9	Billing or payment consultation
Maintenance	#864821	7.09:1	#b54242	Maintenance Visit

Hues avoid the primary, the secondary and the orange-red arc of warning and error, and are at least 0.12 apart in OKLab. They mark dots, event edges and bars; text on them is ink on a 12 percent tint. "General" uses the muted gray.

2.4 Calculated, not chosen

Token	Formula	Result	Use
--color-divider	muted 20 percent over paper	#dddfe3	Dividers, card edges, neutral badge, disabled field
--color-tint	primary 10 percent over paper	#e7effa	Hover fills, selected, information notice

Token	Formula	Result	Use
--color-tint-strong	primary 24 percent over paper	#c4daf3	Pressed fills
--color-primary-hover	primary with 22 percent black	#094da1	Hover (white 8.11:1)
--color-primary-active	primary with 44 percent black	#063773	Pressed (white 11.66:1)
--color-on-dark-muted	paper 72 percent over ink	#bcbfc4	Secondary text on the dark band
--color-success-tint, warning-tint, danger-tint	signal at 12, 16, 10 percent	#e1f4e9, #fef0d8, #fbebea	Notices and badges
--color-danger-hover, danger-active	danger with 22 and 44 percent black	#a82926, #781d1b	Destructive button

3. Typography

Inter Variable, self-hosted (the website policy allows only its own files). Weights 400, 500, 600.

Role	Size (390 / 768 / 1440 px)	Line height	Tracking	Weight
h1	40.5 / 52.6 / 64 px, clamp(2.5rem, 1.75rem + 3.2vw, 4rem)	1.08	-0.02em	600
h2	32 / 39.4 / 44 px, clamp(2rem, 1.5rem + 2vw, 2.75rem)	1.12	-0.02em	600
h3	24 px	1.25	-0.01em	600
Lead	20 px	1.45	0	400
Body	16 px	1.5	0	400
UI (menu, labels, table)	14 px	1.4	0	500
Button	15 px	1	0	600
Caption	12 px	1.4	0	400

Role	Size (390 / 768 / 1440 px)	Line height	Tracking	Weight
Eyebrow	12 px uppercase	1.4	+0.08em	600

Paragraphs stop at 65 characters.

4. Space, layout, shape, elevation, motion

- Space: 4 px base, 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 96 px.
- Layout: container 1240 px, gutter clamp(1rem, 4vw, 2rem), section padding clamp(3rem, 2rem + 4vw, 5rem). Breakpoints 480, 768, 1024, 1280 px.
- Radius: 8 px (controls), 14 px (cards, panels, dialogs), pill (badges).
- Elevation: level 1 cards, level 2 hover and menus, level 3 sticky header, level 4 dialogs, plus an inner pressed shadow.
- Motion: 100, 200, 300, 500 ms; standard and emphasized curves; reduced motion drops transitions to 0.01 ms and removes lifts.

5. Components and states

Component	States
Primary button	Hover: 22 percent darker, lifts 1 px, shadow level 2. Pressed: 44 percent darker, sinks 1 px, inner shadow. Focus: 2 px ring, offset 2 px. Disabled: 38 percent opacity. Loading: spinner
Secondary and ghost buttons	Hover: tint 10 percent, darker text and border. Pressed: tint 24 percent, sinks 1 px
Destructive button	Error signal fill, same hover and pressed steps
Inverse button (dark band)	White fill; hover tint, pressed tint strong
Field	44 px, 16 px text, border muted (6.32:1), visible label, "(required)" in text, error with danger border, icon and sentence
Badge, notice	Tint background, dark text, signal dot or border, icon
Category tag, calendar event	Category dot or 4 px edge, 12 percent tint, ink text
Tabs, accordion, card, table, empty state, legend	Defined in the CSS with hover and selected states

6. Charts

Series	Color	Form
Main measure (Current, Received)	primary	Bars or solid line
Outcome (Completed)	success signal	Bars or 3 px line
Waiting	warning signal	Bars with legend only
Overdue, failed	error signal	Bars or line
Reference (Average call duration, target)	muted	2.5 px dashed line with dot markers
Second measure of the same kind	secondary	Bars with legend only
Appointment purposes	category colors	Bars, dots, event edges

Legend markers are 14 px (22 px dashes for lines) with 14 px labels; the current app uses 11 px markers and 9 to 10 px labels.

7. Migration map (main items)

Item	Today	Proposed
Color variables	30 on the website, six blues across site and app	6 base, 3 semantic pairs, 5 categories, the rest calculated
Font	System font on the website, Inter Variable in the app	Inter Variable on both
Font sizes and weights	20 sizes, 8 weights on the website	9 roles, 3 weights
Smallest text	8 to 10 px	12 px
Touch targets	21 to 36 px in menus and links	44 px
Radii	9 values	3 values
Button states	Hover only on some controls, no pressed state	All states on every control

Item	Today	Proposed
Semantic colors	Dark tones on pale backgrounds	Traffic-light signals with dark text and tints
Category colors	Collided with primary and error	Five clear hues
Page background	#fafafa in the app, mixed tints on the website	#fafafa with white surfaces everywhere

8. Decisions log

1. Palette: three routes were compared against a scan of competitors' colors (blue dominant; violet for AI-forward brands; orange, red and green each used by one competitor). Route A, blue and sun, was chosen: one blue for logo and actions, a warm yellow no direct competitor uses as an accent.
2. One gray, #536173, for secondary text and borders (owner's choice).
3. Semantic colors rebuilt from traffic lights after the first version read as neon green and dark ochre (owner's direction).
4. Button states strengthened after review: steps of about 0.085 in lightness plus position changes.
5. Background #fafafa with white surfaces, as in the current app, after testing #e5e7eb and #eff6ff.
6. Category colors: Tour and Billing at the signal lightness; Lease, Inspection and Maintenance deeper (owner's choice), minimum separation 0.121.
7. Charts: Completed uses the success signal for consistency with the success badge; averages are a dashed gray line.

9. Open decisions

- Logo color: route A moves the logo blue from #0878f9 to #0b63ce. This is the client's decision; logo files were not changed.
- Confirm how the 12 appointment purposes map to the 5 categories.
- Dark mode, an icon set and a full data palette are not included.
- color-mix() is supported by current browsers; for older ones replace calculated tokens with their results.
- Validate type and line breaks on the real pages with Inter loaded.